

2003-32

**Colorado Field Ornithologists Sight Record Form**  
(Please print or type. Attach photographs and additional pages if necessary.)  
***Each table cell will automatically enlarge as you type!***

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| CBRC FILE #: 2003-32                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |                                           |                                                                                                  |
| RESULTS:                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |                                           |                                                                                                  |
| Species: (Common Name) Sprague's Pipit                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | (Scientific Name) <i>Anthus spragueii</i> |                                                                                                  |
| Date(s) of occurrence: 27 April 2003                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |                                           |                                                                                                  |
| Number of birds seen: 1                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | Sex: unknown                              | Plumage: adult, a bit worn                                                                       |
| Exact location: along County Road G in southwestern Baca County, near its crossing of Sand Canyon wash                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |                                           |                                                                                                  |
| County: Baca                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | Nearest town: Campo                       | Elevation: ?                                                                                     |
| Length of observation: 3 to 4 minutes                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |                                           | Time(s) of observation: roughly 1300 hrs. MDT                                                    |
| Other observers who saw the bird(s) with you: Brenda D. Smith-Patten, who independently and quickly identified the bird                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |                                           |                                                                                                  |
| Other observers who independently saw the bird(s): none                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |                                           |                                                                                                  |
| Light conditions (quality; direction relative to bird(s) and observers position: sun overhead and slightly behind us (we were eastbound)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |                                           |                                                                                                  |
| Optical equipment used: Bausch and Lomb Elite 10x42 binoculars                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |                                           |                                                                                                  |
| Distance to bird(s) (estimated, unless otherwise noted): 8 to 10 m                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |                                           |                                                                                                  |
| Was (Were) bird(s) photographed? no                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |                                           | If so, are you submitting photos? N/A                                                            |
| Who took the photograph(s)? N/A                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |                                           |                                                                                                  |
| Describe the general and specific habitats in which the bird(s) occurred: at edge of dirt road in relatively undisturbed shortgrass prairie                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |                                           |                                                                                                  |
| Describe the bird's (birds') behaviors, particularly behaviors that were used in supporting the identification, e.g., flying, feeding, habits: jerked head slightly when walking; did not pump tail; "parachuted" back to the ground after bursting into flight                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |                                           |                                                                                                  |
| <p><b>DESCRIPTION -- This is the most important part of this report.</b> Include in these details the overall size and shape of the bird and give as many plumage details as possible, even including those that you feel might not have relevance to the specific identification. Please fill out this portion even if photos are accompanying your report. The following is a verbatim account from my notes, written the following morning (photocopy attached); clarifying remarks are in brackets: "The <u>Sprague's Pipit</u> was in shortgrass prairie along CR G ~10 km northeast of the Three Corners Monument. We viewed the bird from our car, both of us getting good looks from out my window [I was driving]. The bird was the size and shape (roughly) of an American Pipit, although it was a little plumper, with a slightly shorter tail. The bill was longish and thin, somewhat warbler-like. The legs and feet were pink. It did not 'pump' its tail as it walked. The plumage was distinctive. The dark eye was prominent in the unmarked face. The crown and nape were streaked finely with black, though the streaks widened from the forehead to the nape [mostly on the latter]. The throat was slightly whiter than the face or breast. The breast and belly were warm buff, the breast overlain with a band of black streaks; the breast streaks were short and fine. The flanks were buff, the belly and the undertail coverts whitish. The mantle and scapulars black with buff-white edges, creating a pattern somewhere between scaling and streaking [though decidedly more like the later, as the bird's plumage was a bit worn; also the bird had two dull wingbars]. When the bird jumped into flight it showed ~3 [probably 2!] clean white feathers on either side of the tail. It shot upward at a steep angle, then 'parachuted' back to earth quickly, hiding in dense grass."</p> |                                           |                                                                                                  |
| Describe the bird's (birds') call(s) and/or song(s), if noted: not heard (though I think it did call)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |                                           |                                                                                                  |
| <p><b>SIMILAR SPECIES -- This is another critical part of your report.</b> Please discuss how you eliminated similar species from consideration: pink legs and plumage pattern eliminated American Pipit (<i>A. rubescens</i>) easily; bill size and shape, behavior, overall plumage details (distinctly streaked crown and nape; back pattern; fine breast streaking), lack of white spotting above, etc., eliminated a juvenile Horned Lark (<i>Eremophila alpestris</i>)</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |                                           |                                                                                                  |
| What is your prior experience with this and similarly appearing species? I have seen many juvenile Horned Larks. I have previously seen about 30 Sprague's Pipit, a dozen of them in California (where I found two that were photographed and seen by others), a number of them in Arizona, a few in North Dakota, and stunning views of one—which was basically identical in appearance to the Colorado bird—at the Tallgrass Prairie Preserve in north-central Oklahoma on 13 April 2003.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |                                           |                                                                                                  |
| List books, guides, recordings, or other sources consulted and how these influenced your identification (during and after observation): none                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |                                           |                                                                                                  |
| This report was made from (check one) <input type="checkbox"/> notes made during observation <input checked="" type="checkbox"/> notes made after observation <input type="checkbox"/> later from memory.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |                                           |                                                                                                  |
| Date and time of written report: 16 May 2003                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |                                           |                                                                                                  |
| Reporting observer: Michael A. Patten                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |                                           | Signature:  |
| Reporting observer's address: Sutton Avian Research Center, University of Oklahoma, P.O. Box 2007                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |                                           |                                                                                                  |
| City: Bartlesville                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | State: Oklahoma                           | Zip: 74005                                                                                       |
| <p align="center"><b>Send report to: Colorado Bird Records Committee</b><br/><b>Tony Leukering, PO Box 660, Brighton, CO 80601</b></p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |                                           |                                                                                                  |